1. Purpose

To mitigate biological, physical, and chemical risks, effectively neutralizing human vectors as a primary source of foodborne illness. By harmonizing operational practices with local health mandates and international standards, this protocol ensures total regulatory compliance while safeguarding guest well-being. Ultimately, embedding these standards into the organizational culture protects the company's brand integrity and minimizes legal liability, ensuring that food safety remains a non-negotiable strategic priority.

2. Scope

To establish a unified accountability framework across all departments, requiring every employee—from frontline service to back-of-house operations—to act as a critical link in the company's safety surveillance. By specifically targeting reports of quality degradation, physical contaminants, or potential illness and injury, the procedure ensures that sensory feedback is professionally converted into technical data. This comprehensive coverage prevents the loss of vital information, allowing the management team to conduct immediate root-cause investigations into equipment failures, process deviations, or structural breaches that could compromise consumer health.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. All Employees

Shall be responsible for strict adherence to the hygiene standards outlined in this SOP and for reporting any personal health conditions that may compromise food safety.

3.2. Restaurant Managers

Shall hold the secondary responsibility of providing the necessary resources—such as PPE, sanitized facilities, and adequate training—while conducting rigorous pre-shift inspections to verify compliance. Ultimately, it is the responsibility of every individual to maintain a culture of "Safety First," ensuring that any observed deviations are reported and corrected immediately to mitigate the risk of contamination.

4. Definition of Terms

- **Adulterated**: Food products that are legally classified as contaminated or unsafe because they were handled by a non-compliant employee. This applies to items handled by personnel with unwashed hands, uncovered wounds, or missing protective gear.
- **Beard Snood**: A specialized hair restraint used to manage facial hair safety. It is mandatory for any employee whose facial hair exceeds 1.25 cm or 0.5 inches in length.
- **Biological Hazard**: These consist of living microorganisms (pathogens) that multiply and cause foodborne illnesses. They represent the primary microscopic threat targeted by your hand hygiene protocols.
- **Biological Risks**: Contamination hazards originating from pathogens or microorganisms that cause foodborne illness. These include infectious agents such as *Salmonella*, E. Coli, Norovirus, and Hepatitis A.
- **Chemical Hazard**: Toxic substances that can cause acute poisoning or long-term health complications if they contaminate food.

- **Chemical Risks**: Potential chemical-based safety hazards that must be neutralized to prevent toxic food contamination and safeguard guest well-being.
- **Exclude**: An immediate management action where an employee is sent home and prohibited from working in the facility. This action is triggered by symptoms like vomiting, diarrhea, jaundice, and sore throat with fever, or confirmed medical diagnoses.
- **Human Vectors**: Personnel who act as a primary vehicle, carrier, or source for transferring biological, physical, or chemical contamination to food products.
- **Just-in-Time Retraining**: Immediate educational intervention conducted by the Restaurant Manager right after a hygiene violation is observed. It reinforces the safety rationale behind the protocol before the employee is permitted to resume their duties.
- **Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)**: Protective gear provided by management to maintain a sanitary food preparation environment. Examples within this protocol include aprons, clean hats, hairnets, and beard snoods.
- **Physical Hazard**: Any extraneous or foreign physical object not naturally occurring in food that poses a risk of choking, cuts, or physical trauma to the consumer.
- **Physical Risks**: Foreign objects or materials that can accidentally contaminate food and pose a physical hazard to consumers. Items like unapproved jewelry, watches, chipped nail polish, or false nails fall under this category.
- **Restrict**: A control measure that removes an employee from direct food-handling duties and reassigns them to non-food tasks. This is required if they have infected cuts, boils, or sores, which must also be safely covered with a waterproof bandage and a glove.
- **Stop-and-Discard Protocol**: A mandatory product disposition protocol executed immediately during a hygiene failure to mitigate hazards. It requires the prompt destruction and disposal of any food items handled by non-compliant staff.
- **Trend Analysis**: A periodic evaluation conducted by management to review documented hygiene breaches over time. It transitions the facility from reactive fixes to data-driven root cause analysis to identify recurring systemic failures and drive long-term improvements.

5. Personal Cleanliness and Appearance

- **Daily Hygiene:** All employees must bathe or shower daily before arriving at work.
- **Fingernails (Store Employees):** Nails must be kept, short, clean, and neatly trimmed. Nail polish, acrylics, or false nails are strictly prohibited as they can chip or fall into food (physical hazard) and harbor bacteria.
- **Hair Restraint (Store Employees):** Must wear clean hats, hairnets, or other effective hair restraints that fully cover all hair. Beard snoods are required for facial hair exceeding 1.25cm (0.5 inch) in length.

6. Proper Attire and Protective Clothing

- **Uniform Integrity:** All employees must arrive in clean clothing. For store employees, uniforms must not be worn to and from work to avoid environmental contamination.
- **Aprons:** Must be removed and hung in a designated area before leaving the food preparation zone.
- **Jewelry Policy:** To minimize physical hazards and bacterial niches, the only permitted jewelry is a plain, smooth wedding band. Visible watches and stud earrings for receptionists.

7. Employee Health and Illness Reporting

Condition	Action Required
Symptoms (Vomiting, Diarrhea, Jaundice, Sore Throat with Fever)	**Exclude:** Employees must be sent home immediately
Infected Wounds (Cuts, Boils, or Sores)	**Restrict:** Cover with a waterproof bandage and a glove; move to non-food tasks.
Diagnosis (Salmonella, E.Coli, Norovirus, Hepatitis A)	**Report:** Local health authorities must be notified; employee is excluded until cleared by a physician

8. Hygienic Work Practices

- **Eating and Drinking:** Consuming food or beverages is permitted only in designated break areas. Closed beverage containers with a straw and lid may be allowed in some jurisdictions, provided they are stored away from preparation surfaces.
- **Smoking/Vaping:** Prohibited in all food handling and storage areas.
- **Tasting Food:** Use a clean, sanitized utensil for every taste test. Never use fingers on the same spoon twice.

9. Corrective Action

- **Immediate Management Intervention:** The Restaurant Manager maintains operational safety through continuous behavioral monitoring, requiring the immediate removal of any employee observed violating hygiene protocols regarding attire, jewelry, or hair restraints. Beyond the immediate rectification of these physical deficiencies, the Restaurant Manager must conduct "just-in-time" retraining to reinforce the underlying safety rationale and ensure procedural understanding before the store employee resumes duty. Furthermore, this oversight necessitates the mandatory health exclusion of any employee exhibiting symptoms of illness, ensuring strict adherence to local health codes to prevent potential disease transmission.
- **Product Disposition and Hazard Mitigation:** In the event of a hygiene failure, the store must implement a "Stop-and-Discard" protocol to mitigate potential biological or physical hazards. This requires the immediate disposal of any food items handled by non-compliant store employee—such as those with unwashed hands, uncovered wounds, or missing protective equipment—as these products are legally deemed adulterated.
- **Root Cause Analysis and Documentation:** All significant hygiene breaches must be formally documented within a **Corrective Action Request Form *(IQAF-001)***, detailing the nature of the deviation, the employee involved, and the specific disposition of any adulterated products. This rigorous record-keeping enables management to perform periodic Trend Analyses, identifying recurring failures that may signal a need for systemic improvements, such as revised training programs or infrastructural upgrades. By

transitioning from reactive fixes to data-driven root cause analysis, the facility and store ensures long-term compliance and continuous improvement of its food safety culture.

10. Verification

This SOP is verified through monthly internal audits and annual reviews of food safety records to ensure the hygiene program remains effective against evolving risks

11. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	February 10, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA Specialist**	Originator
1	March 06, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA Specialist**	• Change the addressing of personnel; staff members to employees • Change the personnel responsibility from Operations Manager to Restaurant Managers • Added additional signatory; L&D Manager
2	June 2, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Added Definition of Terms

	Name	Position	Signature with Date
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